



Mini GTX 960

Mini-ITX system builders rejoice! ASUS has once again launched a miniaturised version of a GPU and this time it's the GTX 960 Mini. <http://dgit.in/Mini960>

Rules of Typography

As there are millions of typefaces available online, here are some rules that you should definitely follow to use them effectively. <http://dgit.in/TypoComm>

Xiaomi Mi4

Did Xiaomi finally get it wrong?



We had first spent some time with the Mi4 in October last year and if you had read the Hands On on the website, you would know that we weren't thrilled with the glossy back. Well, that remains the same. While the Mi4 is a very sturdily built device, which feels premium enough, the glossy back makes it a little slippery.

That said, it is also a small misstep in an otherwise well built device. The metal rim around the side of the phone feels good and it is compact enough to be used with one hand. While the Mi4 does feel slightly heavy when compared to some other smartphones, it isn't heavy enough to really be a problem.

On the build and design aspect, this phone will get a lot of points, whichever way you look at it.

Moving to the display, it is quite warm, with a generous dose of yellow in the colours. While this is an IPS panel, the colours on the display make it seem more like an AMOLED panel. The warmth is quite like what you get on Samsung devices, so the decision would naturally depend on whether you like such displays. It's definitely one of the better displays in this price range.

At ₹19,999, the Mi4 is one of the cheapest Snapdragon 801-powered smartphones you can buy today. Also, that puts it squarely in competition against the OnePlus One, with others like the Lenovo Vibe X2 and Huawei Honor 6 also posing a threat. In terms of pure performance, the Mi4 is

every bit the performer. Remember though, the phone has two performance modes — the balanced mode clocks the processor down to around 300 Mhz per core, while the Performance mode leaves it to perform with all its might. If you're gaming on balanced mode, with a lot of background tasks, you may see some lags, but the performance mode deals with high end gaming and multitasking well.

For regular usage, you may want to keep the Mi4 at the Balanced mode, as this does offer a higher battery life, but switch it back to Performance later.

What's disappointing though is that with above average gaming and web browsing, the Mi4 couldn't last us through the day. In fact, we could never really get the phone to last more than about 10 hours at best. On our battery test, the Mi4 can last for just below 7 hours, while competitors like the OnePlus One and Huawei Honor 6 last 10 hours each.

It does have fast charging though and doesn't take much time to charge, with our only issue being in the fact that the charger itself malfunctioned a few times. That of course was a device specific issue.

Next the camera. Images taken by the Mi4 came overexposed sometimes. That said, the focus dot, which doubles up as the exposure control will help you fix this. The fact that it shows you how the picture is going to be in real time allows you to take good shots. If you're more of a point-and-shoot kind of camera user, then the Huawei Honor 6 and OnePlus One both present better options for you. The Mi4 on the other hand will be loved by camera enthusiasts.

To conclude, the Mi4 is definitely a good smartphone, but would you really want to spend ₹20,000 on a 16GB smartphone? The 64GB variant of the device costs ₹23,999, which again makes it more expensive than the OnePlus One. As mentioned above, there's no denying that it is a good phone, but if you're looking for the absolute best device in this price segment, you should be going for the OnePlus One.



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Specifications

Display: 5 inch 1080p;
Processor: 2.5GHz
Qualcomm Snapdragon
801; **RAM:** 3GB; **Storage:**
16/64 GB; **Camera:** 13MP
rear, 8MP front; **Battery:**
3100 mAh; **OS:** Android
4.4.4 with MIUI 6

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